#Digital Literacy Portfolio Project Report

Title Page

Name: Kuldeep Parmar

Registration Number: 25MIM10235

Branch: Integrated M.Tech

Year: 1st Year

Course: CSE0001 - Digital Literacy

Introduction

This project was completed as part of the Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. As a Student Digital Ambassador, my goal was to build a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio demonstrating key skills including professional online presence, effective communication, cybercrime awareness, and familiarity with collaboration tools.

The project consists of five tasks, each addressing a critical aspect of digital literacy. All work is organized in a GitHub repository, serving as a permanent part of my professional portfolio.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Infographic

Tool Used:

I created my digital literacy infographic using **Canva**, a free browser-based graphic design tool. Canva offers templates and icons that make it easy to create professional-looking visuals.

What My Design Shows:

My infographic, titled "Digital Literacy," is organized into three clear sections:

1. **What is Digital Literacy?** – I defined it as "the ability to find, evaluate, create, and communicate information using digital technologies."

2. **Safe Internet Practices** – I included three tips: using strong passwords with 8+ characters and symbols, enabling two-factor authentication, and avoiding public Wi-Fi for sensitive transactions.

3. **Professional Online Presence** – I highlighted keeping LinkedIn updated, using professional email addresses, and cleaning up social media privacy settings.

Reflection:

One challenge I faced was condensing all the information into a clean, scannable layout. I solved this by using bullet points instead of long paragraphs and adding clear section headers. I found it interesting how effective simple visuals can be for communicating important ideas.

Task 2: Student Digital Portfolio

Platforms I Chose:

1. **GitHub** – A code hosting platform where developers share projects. I created a profile README with my name, branch, year, and learning goal. I will use GitHub to upload all my course projects and build a portfolio for future employers.

2. **LinkedIn** – The leading professional networking platform. I completed my Education section with VIT Bhopal University and expected graduation year. I plan to use LinkedIn to connect with alumni and follow companies I'm interested in.

3. **Kaggle** – A platform for data science competitions and datasets. I created a basic profile and plan to participate in beginner competitions to develop my data science skills.

Future Plans:

Over the next four years, I will maintain these platforms actively. GitHub will showcase my coding journey, LinkedIn will help me build a professional network, and Kaggle will develop my data science skills. Together, they will create a strong digital presence for internships and placements.

Task 3: Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Part A - Coding Practice:

I used **HackerRank** and completed the "Hello, World!" Python challenge. The platform provides a beginner-friendly interface with problem statements and a code editor. I received a success message for test case 0, confirming my solution was correct.

Part B - Google Workspace:

I created a **Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz** with 5 questions using Google Forms. The form includes multiple-choice questions covering digital literacy definition, strong passwords, professional networking, OTP safety, and phishing. I linked responses to Google Sheets for easy tracking.

Academic Benefits:

HackerRank will help me practice coding regularly, preparing for technical interviews. Google Forms can be used for class surveys, project feedback, and event registrations—skills I can share with peers as a Digital Ambassador.

Task 4: Email Etiquette

Part A - Professional Emails:

I drafted two professional emails:

1. **To Professor:** Requesting a 2-day extension for the Digital Literacy project

2. **To Internship Coordinator:** Expressing interest in summer internship opportunities

Both emails include clear subject lines, professional greetings, well-structured bodies, and proper sign-offs.

Part B - Social Media Checklist:

I created a checklist with 5 Do's and 5 Don'ts for responsible social media use. Key points include using privacy settings, thinking before posting, and never sharing sensitive information.

Reflection:

A scenario where poor digital communication caused a problem: A student sent an internship application with no subject line, informal greeting, and incomplete information. The email was ignored by the recruiter. This taught me that first impressions happen through email before any interview. Professional communication reflects work ethic and attention to detail.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness

Case Study - Phishing:

Phishing is a cybercrime where attackers impersonate legitimate organizations to steal sensitive information. It typically involves target identification, crafting fake emails/websites, delivery via email/SMS, victim action, and exploitation of stolen data. College students are frequently targeted through fake internship offers. Consequences include financial loss, identity theft, and academic account compromise.

Prevention Checklist:

I created a "Stay Safe Online" checklist with 8+ actionable tips covering password security, UPI/financial safety, email safety, and mobile security. I included reporting channels: cybercrime.gov.in and helpline 1930.

Reflection:

What surprised me most was how sophisticated phishing attacks have become—attackers now use AI for perfect grammar and create convincing fake websites. One habit I will change is never clicking links in emails; instead, I will type the official URL directly into my browser. I will also enable Two-Factor Authentication on all accounts.

Conclusion

This project enhanced my understanding of digital literacy across multiple dimensions. I learned practical skills in visual design, professional networking, collaboration tools, email communication, and cybersecurity. The GitHub repository I created will serve as a lasting portfolio component. As a Student Digital Ambassador, I am now better equipped to help peers navigate the digital world safely and professionally.

References

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- National Cyber Crime Portal: cybercrime.gov.in